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Ministerial Resolution No. 34

OFFICIAL TITLE
Ministerial Resolution No. 340 of 2026 Concerning the Wage Protection System

INSTRUMENT
Ministerial Resolution No. 340 of 2026

ISSUED BY
Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE)

JURISDICTION
UAE Federal

STATUS
IN FORCE

TOPICS
Wages Protection System · Employment

OFFICIAL SOURCE
u.ae

FULL TEXT
English official text — 4 passages, 1,116 words, from the official text

VERIFIED
25 October 2026

The current Wage Protection System rules: wages fall due on the first day of each month and at least 85% of wages due must pass through WPS-authorised channels. Measures escalate

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Summary

Ministerial Resolution No. 340 of 2026 is the current Wage Protection System (WPS) instrument of the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation. Its text is not published on the federal legislation portal; the official position below is taken from the UAE Government portal page on payment of wages, last updated 14 October 2026, which states that wages are paid in accordance with Ministerial Resolution No. 340 of 2026 and sets out the timetable it imposes. It supersedes Ministerial Resolution No. 598 of 2022.

Establishments registered with the Ministry must pay wages on the due date through WPS, that is through banks, exchange houses or financial institutions authorised by the Central Bank. Salaries for the previous month fall due on the first day of each Gregorian month, and an employer must transfer at least 85% of total wages due on time, allowing for lawful deductions. Payment is in UAE dirhams unless the contract agrees another currency. The Labour Law sets no minimum wage, though it requires wages sufficient to meet basic needs.

The escalation runs from the due date. From day one every establishment is monitored electronically. On day two non-compliant establishments receive notifications. On day five new work permits are suspended with a warning to pay. On day 11 an administrative fine applies under Cabinet Resolution No. 21 of 2020 and, for a repeat violation within six months, the establishment is reclassified to the third category under Ministerial Resolution No. 209 of 2022. On day 16 individual or collective labour disputes are registered automatically for the affected workers and permits are suspended for large employers of 25 or more workers in listed sectors or commonly owned groups meeting that threshold. On day 21 an establishment with fewer than 50 workers faces an executive instrument for payment and one with 50 or more faces collective dispute procedures; precautionary attachment, a travel ban on the person in charge and referral to the Public Prosecution for repeat violations within two consecutive months also apply.

Excluded employees are those with wage complaints before the courts, reported absconders, those whose liberty is restricted, those on documented unpaid leave, seafarers on request,

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Who it applies to

Every establishment registered with the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation and the workers it employs, which covers mainland and non-financial free zone employers. Excluded: nationals' fishing boats and public taxis, banks and financial institutions, houses of worship, and listed worker categories such as absconders, workers on documented unpaid leave and seafarers.

Contents

English official text in 4 passages. Open the full text or jump to a provision:

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Key provisions

Section: When should employers pay salaries?	Wages for the previous month fall due on the first day of each Gregorian month and must be paid through WPS; at least 85% of total wages due must be transferred on time after lawful deductions.
Section: When should employers pay salaries?	Day 2: notifications and alerts to non-compliant establishments. Day 5: new work permits suspended with a warning to pay.

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salaries?	
Section: When should employers pay salaries?	Day 16: automatic registration of individual or collective labour disputes and permit suspension for employers of 25 or more workers in listed sectors or commonly owned groups. Day 21: executive payment instrument or collective dispute procedure, precautionary attachment, travel ban and prosecution for repeats within two months.
Section: How should salaries/wages be paid?	Wages are transferred through banks, exchange houses or financial institutions authorised by the Central Bank, which built WPS so the Ministry can keep a database of private-sector wage payments; payment is in dirhams unless another currency is agreed.
Section: Categories excluded from WPS compliance	Excluded workers include those with wage complaints before the courts, reported absconders, workers whose liberty is restricted, documented unpaid leave, seafarers, foreign staff paid abroad with consent and mission permits up to three months; excluded employers are nationals' fishing boats and taxis, banks and houses of worship.
Section: Report unpaid or delayed salaries	Workers may contact the Ministry or file a salary complaint; the page states that wages are paid in accordance with Ministerial Resolution No. 340 of 2026 concerning the Wage Protection System.

Obligations and deadlines

- Pay the previous month's wages through WPS by the first day of each Gregorian month.
- Transfer at least 85% of total wages due on time, documenting any lawful deduction.
- Clear any shortfall within five days, after which new work permits are suspended.
- Avoid a repeat default within six months, which brings fines and third-category reclassification.
- Notify the Ministry of unpaid leave and other exemptions with supporting documents.
- Keep WPS records and evidence of payment available for Ministry monitoring.

Penalties

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registered automatically from day 16, and from day 21 the Ministry may use executive payment instruments, collective dispute procedures, precautionary attachment, a travel ban on the person in charge and referral to the Public Prosecution for repeat violations within two consecutive months. The portal gives no fine amounts.

History and citations

Repeals	Ministerial Resolution No. 598 of 2022

"Cites" and "Cited by" are built automatically from references in the full texts held in this library; they cover only instruments in the library.

Related instruments

WPS Resolution 2022 (superseded)

MR 598/2022 · UAE FEDERAL · SUPERSEDED

FULL TEXT

The 2022 WPS framework, now replaced: wages were late after 15 days, new work permits were suspended from day 17, employers with over 50 workers faced inspection and pros…

UAE Labour Law

FDL 33/2021 · UAE FEDERAL · IN FORCE (AMENDED)

FULL TEXT

The principal private-sector employment law: fixed-term contracts, work permits, probation, working hours, leave, wages, termination, end-of-service gratuity, non-compete…

Labour Law Executive Regulations

CR 1/2022 · UAE FEDERAL · IN FORCE

FULL TEXT

Implements the Labour Law: defines the twelve work-permit types (including freelance, part-time, temporary and juvenile permits), the contract models (full-time, part-tim…

Classification of Private Sector Establishments

CR 18/2022 · UAE FEDERAL · IN FORCE

FULL TEXT

Sorts MoHRE-registered establishments into three categories that drive work-permit fees and incentives. Category 1 requires full compliance with labour, permit, contract …

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FULL TEXT

Requires MoHRE-registered establishments with 50 or more workers to raise the Emirati share of skilled jobs by 2 percentage points a year, reaching 10% by 2026. Non-compl…

Related Polaris services

- Payroll Services & WPS UAE
- PRO Services Dubai — Visa, Licensing
- Mainland Company Formation UAE

Source and verification. This record was written from the official text published at u.ae, read on 25 October 2026. Quoted from that text: *"Salaries for the previous month are due on the first day of each Gregorian month."*

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